Maize (corn) - Northern leaf blight (Turcicum leaf blight)

RAG record ADV-003 | canonical key: maize_northern_leaf_blight

Record ID	ADV-003
Crop / crop key	Maize (corn) / maize
Condition / disease key	Northern leaf blight (Turcicum leaf blight) / northern_leaf_blight
Main pathogen	Exserohilum turcicum (syn. Helminthosporium turcicum)
RAG aliases	northern leaf blight, turcicum leaf blight, TLB, Exserohilum turcicum, maize leaf blight

Farmer quick guide: treatments protect healthy plant tissue and slow disease spread. Dead or badly damaged leaf tissue will not become green again.

How to recognize it

- Long cigar-shaped grey-green to tan lesions usually start on lower leaves.
- Lesions can become 2.5-15 cm long and may join together until a large part of the leaf looks burnt.

Weather or field conditions that favour it

Cool, wet and humid weather helps the disease develop. The fungus survives in infected maize debris.

What to do now

- Remove or bury infected stubble after harvest and avoid carrying heavy residue pressure into the next maize crop.
- Use resistant hybrids where available and scout from the lower canopy upward.
- Spray only after confirming the disease and use one locally registered option.

Chemical treatment - only after the disease is confirmed

Chemical / formulation	Rate from cited source	How to use this information	Source
Mancozeb or zineb	2-4 g/L water	TNAU recommends spraying after first disease appearance and repeating at about 10-day intervals when needed.	[S1]
Propiconazole 25% EC	1 ml/L water	TNAU also lists propiconazole at 35 and 50 days after sowing in its maize leaf-blight guidance.	[S1]

Safety and compliance: Use only a product whose current Indian label allows the crop and target disease. Follow the label rate, water volume, re-entry interval and pre-harvest interval. Wear label-required PPE. Do not mix products unless the label or a qualified extension adviser permits it.

Prevention and integrated management

- Use resistant/tolerant hybrids.
- Rotate crops and manage infected residue.
- Avoid overly dense canopies where practical.

RAG guardrail

The AI should treat the chemical table as source-grounded examples, not permission to invent a different pesticide or dose. If the retrieved source does not match the crop, disease and formulation, return non-chemical advice and request local verification.

Sources used for this record

[S1] Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU). Maize - Leaf Blight / Turcicum Leaf Blight.
https://agritech.tnau.ac.in/crop_protection/maize_disease_new/maize_2.html